

The Discourse on the Path of Practice

Paṭipadāsutta (SN 12.3)

Sāvatthiyaṃ viharati ...pe...

“micchāpaṭipadañca vo, bhikkhave, desessāmi sammāpaṭipadañca. Taṃ suṇātha, sādhukaṃ manasi karotha, bhāssissāmi”ti.

Staying near Sāvatthī... and so on...

“Monks, I will teach you the wrong path of practice (*micchāpaṭipadā*) and the right path of practice (*sammāpaṭipadā*). Listen, pay close attention, and I will speak.”

“Evaṃ, bhante”ti kho te bhikkhū bhagavato paccassosun. Bhagavā etadavoca:

“Yes, Bhante,” those monks replied to the Blessed One. The Blessed One said this:

“Katamā ca, bhikkhave, micchāpaṭipadā? Avijjāpaccayā, bhikkhave, saṅkhārā;

saṅkhārapaccayā viññāṇaṃ ...pe... evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa samudayo hoti. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, micchāpaṭipadā.

“And what, monks, is the wrong path of practice? With ignorance (*avijjā*) as condition, mental conditioning (*saṅkhāras*) arise; with mental conditioning as condition, consciousness (*viññāṇa*) arises... and so on... Thus is the origin of this entire mass of suffering. This, monks, is called the wrong path of practice.

Katamā ca, bhikkhave, sammāpaṭipadā? Avijjāya tveva asesavirāganirodhā saṅkhāranirodho; saṅkhāranirodhā viññāṇanirodho ...pe... evametassa kevalassa dukkhakkhandhassa nirodho hoti. Ayaṃ vuccati, bhikkhave, sammāpaṭipadā”ti.

“And what, monks, is the right path of practice? But with the complete fading away and cessation of ignorance, mental conditioning ceases; with the cessation of mental conditioning, consciousness ceases... and so on... Thus is the cessation of this entire mass of suffering. This, monks, is called the right path of practice.”

Tatiyaṃ.

(Third)

Glossary

Pāli (IAST)	Target transliteration	Target gloss	First-chapter occurrence	Goenka-tradition usage
micchāpaṭipadā	micchāpaṭipadā	wrong path of practice	The Discourse on the Path of Practice	The incorrect way of practice that leads to the arising of suffering through the chain of dependent origination.
sammāpaṭipadā	sammāpaṭipadā	right path of practice	The Discourse on the Path of Practice	The correct way of practice that leads to the cessation of suffering through the cessation of the chain.
avijjā	avijjā	ignorance	The Discourse on the Path of Practice	Lack of experiential understanding of the Four Noble Truths.
saṅkhāra	saṅkhāra	mental conditioning	The Discourse on the Path of Practice	Mental reactions that accumulate and drive the cycle of existence.
viññāṇa	viññāṇa	consciousness	The Discourse on the Path of Practice	The cognitive aspect of the mind that notes the presence of an object.

Translator Notes

1. **Intimate Teacher-to-Student Voice:** The English translation maintains a direct and experiential tone, matching Goenkaji's spoken style.
2. **Path of Practice (paṭipadā):** Translated as "path of practice" to capture both the active journey and the pragmatic methodology of Vipassana.
3. **Arises/Ceases in Abbreviated Chain:** Repeated the verbs "arises" and "ceases" for each initial link in the abbreviated dependent origination chain to maintain clarity and cadence.